

RAJESH CHAUNSALI

Curriculum Vitae

205, Department of Aerospace Engineering,
Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru – 560012

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Solid and Structural Mechanics
- Vibrations and Wave Physics
- Metamaterials and Lattice Structures
- Deployable Space Structures

EDUCATIONAL HISTORY

Ph.D., Aeronautics and Astronautics (2014–2018)

University of Washington, Seattle
Advisor: Prof. Jinkyu ‘JK’ Yang

B.Tech. & M.Tech., Mechanical Engineering (2007–2012)

Indian Institute of Technology Madras, Chennai
Minor in Physics

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru

- Assistant Professor, Department of Aerospace Engineering (2021–present)

Laboratoire d’Acoustique Le Mans Université (LAUM), CNRS, Le Mans

- Postdoctoral Fellow (2018–2021)

University of Washington, Seattle

- Graduate Research Assistant (2015–2018)

GE Aerospace, Bengaluru

- Edison Engineer (2012–2014)

AWARDS AND HONORS

- **Young Associate**, Indian National Academy of Engineering (2024)
- **Visiting Fellow**, CNRS, France (2023, 2024)
- **Start-up Research Grant (SRG)**, Science and Engineering Research Board, India (2022)
- **Editor’s Suggestion paper**, Physical Review Applied (2019)
- **Student Award Nominee: Research** for excellence in graduate research, College of Engineering, UW (2018)
- **Editor’s Choice paper: Topological matter**, Scientific Reports (2018)
- **Student Research Representative**, AeroAstro Visiting Committee, UW (2016)

- **Student Award Nominee: Teaching**, one of four nominees for excellence in teaching assistantship, College of Engineering, UW (2016)
- **S. Rao and Usha Varanasi Fellowship**, AeroAstro, UW (2015)
- **Graduate School Top Scholar Award**, UW (2014)
- **LEAD Expo Winner**, General Electric (2013)
- **Undergraduate Research Fellowship**, Indian Institute of Science (2009)
- **Mathematics Olympiad**, Silver medal, Chennai Mathematical Institute (2009)
- **Merit Scholarship**, Central Board of Secondary Education (2007–2011)
- **Regional Mathematics Olympiad**, State Rank 5 (2006)

PUBLICATIONS

Refereed Archival Journal Publications

*Lab members and visiting scholars underlined; *Corresponding author; †Equally contributing first authors*

30. G. S. Srikanth[†], K. Qian[†], I. Frankel[†], G. Theocharis, N. Boechler, **R. Chaunsali**^{*}, “Single-particle limit of a topological edge state in a locally resonant band gap”, *npj Acoustics* (accepted).
29. H. K. Sandhu, S. Dutta, **R. Chaunsali**^{*}, “Wave propagation in an elastic lattice with nonreciprocal stiffness and engineered damping,” *Journal of the Acoustical Society of America* 159, 978, 2026.
28. K. Prabith, G. Theocharis, **R. Chaunsali**^{*}, “Nonlinearity-induced corner states in a kagome lattice,” *New Journal of Physics* 27 083501, 2025.
27. U. Vishwakarma, M. Irfan, G. Theocharis, **R. Chaunsali**^{*}, “Edge States with Hidden Topology in Spinner Lattices,” *Communications Physics* 8, 83, 2025.
26. A. Ray[†], S. Anand[†], V. Dabade, **R. Chaunsali**^{*}, “Remote Nucleation and Stationary Domain Walls via Transition Waves in Tristable Magnetoelastic Lattices,” *Physical Review Materials* 9, 014405, 2025.
25. K. Prabith, G. Theocharis, **R. Chaunsali**^{*}, “Nonlinear corner states in a topologically nontrivial kagome lattice,” *Physical Review B* 110, 104307, 2024.
24. **R. Chaunsali**^{*}, P. G. Kevrekidis, D. Frantzeskakis, G. Theocharis, “Dirac Solitons and Topological Edge States in the β -Fermi-Pasta-Ulam-Tsingou dimer lattice,” *Physical Review E* 108, 054224, 2023.
23. F. Allein[†], A. Anastasiadis[†], **R. Chaunsali**[†], I. Frankel, N. Boechler, F. K. Diakonov, G. Theocharis, “Strain topological metamaterials and revealing hidden topology in higher-order coordinates,” *Nature Communications* 14, 6633, 2023.
22. X. Shi, **R. Chaunsali**, G. Theocharis, H. Huang, R. Zhu, J. Yang, “Topological phase transition in disordered elastic quantum spin Hall system,” *Physical Review B* 108, 054205, 2023.
21. Y. Miyazawa, C. Chen, **R. Chaunsali**, T. S. Gormley, G. Yin, G. Theocharis, J. Yang, “Topological state transfer in Kresling origami,” *Communications Materials* 3, 1-10, 2022.
20. A. Anastasiadis, G. Styliaris, **R. Chaunsali**, G. Theocharis, and F. K. Diakonov, “Bulk-edge correspondence in the trimer Su-Schrieffer-Heeger model,” *Physical Review B* 106, 085109, 2022.
19. B. M. Manda, **R. Chaunsali**, G. Theocharis, C. Skokos, “Nonlinear Topological Edge States: from Dynamic Delocalization to Thermalization,” *Physical Review B* 105, 104308, 2022.

Prior to joining IISc:

18. X. Shi, I. Kiorpelidis, **R. Chaunsali**, V. Achilleos, G. Theocharis, J. Yang, “Disorder-induced topological phase transition in a one-dimensional mechanical system,” *Physical Review Research* 3, 033012, 2021.

17. C. Chen[†], **R. Chaunsali**[†], J. Christensen, G. Theocharis, J. Yang , “Corner states in a second-order mechanical topological insulator,” *Communications Materials* 2, 1, 2021.
16. **R. Chaunsali***, H. Xu, J. Yang, P. G. Kevrekidis, G. Theocharis, “Stability of topological edge states under strong nonlinear effects,” *Physical Review B* 103, 024106, 2021.
15. **R. Chaunsali***, G. Theocharis, “Self-induced topological transition in phononic crystals by nonlinearity management,” *Physical Review B* 100, 014302, 2019.
14. C. Chen, N. Lera, **R. Chaunsali**, D. Torrent, J. Vicente Alvarez, J. Yang, P. San-Jose, J. Christensen, “Mechanical analogue of a Majorana bound state,” *Advanced Materials* 31, 1904386, 2019.
13. E. Kim, **R. Chaunsali**, J. Yang, “Gradient-index granular crystals: From boomerang motion to asymmetric transmission of waves,” *Physical Review Letters* 123, 214301, 2019.
12. X. Shi, **R. Chaunsali**, F. Li, J. Yang, “Elastic Weyl points and surface arc states in three-dimensional structures,” *Physical Review Applied* 12, 024058, 2019 (**Editor’s Suggestion**).
11. **R. Chaunsali**, C. Chen, J. Yang, “Experimental demonstration of topological waveguiding in elastic plate with local resonators,” *New Journal of Physics* 20, 113036, 2018.
10. **R. Chaunsali**, E. Kim, J. Yang, “Demonstration of accelerating and decelerating nonlinear impulse waves in functionally graded granular chains,” *Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society A* 376 (2127), 20170136, 2018 (**invited**).
9. X. Shi, **R. Chaunsali**, Y. Wu, J. Yang, “Elastic Wannier-Stark ladders and Bloch oscillations in 1D granular crystals,” *Journal of Applied Physics* 123, 104904, 2018 (**invited**).
8. **R. Chaunsali**, C. Chen, J. Yang, “Subwavelength and directional control of flexural waves in zone-folding induced topological plates,” *Physical Review B* 97, 054307, 2018.
7. Y. Wu, **R. Chaunsali**, H. Yasuda, K. Yu, J. Yang, “Dial-in topological metamaterial based on bistable Stewart platform,” *Scientific Reports* 8, 112, 2018 (**Editor’s Choice**).
6. **R. Chaunsali**, E. Kim, A. Thakkar, P. G. Kevrekidis, J. Yang, “Demonstrating an in situ topological band transition in granular crystals,” *Physical Review Letters* 119, 024301, 2017.
5. **R. Chaunsali**, M. Toles, J. Yang, E. Kim, “Extreme control of impulse transmission by cylinder based nonlinear phononic crystals,” *Journal of the Mechanics and Physics of Solids* 107, 21-32, 2017.
4. **R. Chaunsali**, H. Xu, J. Yang, P. G. Kevrekidis, “Linear and nonlinear dynamics of isospectral granular chains,” *Journal of Physics A: Mathematical and Theoretical* 50, 175201, 2017.
3. **R. Chaunsali**, F. Li, J. Yang, “Stress wave isolation by purely mechanical topological phononic crystals,” *Scientific Reports* 6, 30662, 2016.
2. E. Kim, **R. Chaunsali**, H. Xu, J. Castillo, J. Yang, P. G. Kevrekidis, A. F. Vakakis, “Nonlinear low-to-high frequency energy cascades in diatomic granular crystals,” *Physical Review E* 92, 062201, 2015.
1. T. J. Royston, Z. Dai, **R. Chaunsali**, Y. Liu, Y. Peng, R. L. Magin, “Estimating material viscoelastic properties based on surface wave measurements: A comparison of techniques and modeling assumptions,” *Journal of the Acoustical Society of America* 130 (6), 4126, 2011.

Conference Proceedings

1. A. Anshuman, **R. Chaunsali***, “Transition Wave-Induced Deployment of a Multistable Space Structure,” Global Space Exploration Conference, GLEX-25,8,3,3,x92710, 2025.

OTHER SCHOLARLY ACTIVITY

Seminars and Invited talks

- *National Institute of Technology Silchar*, SPARC Workshop, Feb 2026.
- *Kyoto University*, Seminar in the Department of Aeronautics and Astronautics, Dec 2025.
- *Seoul National University*, Seminar in the Department of Mechanical Engineering, June 2025.
- *Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur*, Mechanical Sciences Young Investigators Meet, Kanpur, India, March 2025.
- *Seoul National University*, Online seminar in the Department of Mechanical Engineering, Nov 2024.
- *Indian Institute of Technology Delhi*, Talk at Indo-German Science & Technology Centre (IGSTC) workshop, Delhi, Sept 2024.
- *Laboratoire d'Acoustique de l'Université du Mans (LAUM)*, CNRS, France, Aug 2024.
- *Laboratoire d'Acoustique de l'Université du Maine (LAUM)*, CNRS, Seminar at the 6th Local Symmetry Workshop, Le Mans, France, July 2023.
- *Mechanical Engineering, Indian Institute of Science*, Bengaluru, April 2022.
- *Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar*, Symposium on Applied Mechanics and Dynamics, March 2022.
- *Indian Institute of Technology Bombay*, Mumbai, March 2021.
- *University of Sheffield*, UK, Dec 2020 (online).
- *Laboratoire d'Acoustique de l'Université du Mans (LAUM)*, CNRS, France, Dec 2020 (online).
- *Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar*, Dec 2019.
- *Indian Institute of Space Science and Technology*, Thiruvananthapuram, Dec 2019.
- *Indian Institute of Science Education and Research*, Thiruvananthapuram, Dec 2019.
- *Indian Institute of Technology Madras*, Chennai, Nov 2019.
- *Harbin Institute of Technology*, Harbin, China, Jun 2018.
- *AeroAstro Review Committee*, University of Washington, Seattle, WA, Nov 2016.

Conference presentations

19. “New tools to shape topological boundary states: hidden symmetry and nonlinearity,” *KOZWaves 2026*, Sydney, Australia, Jan 2026 (invited).
18. “New tools to shape topological boundary states: hidden symmetry and nonlinearity,” *International Symposium on Topological Wave Science 2025*, Okayama, Japan, Dec 2025 (invited).
17. “New tools to shape topological boundary states: hidden symmetry and nonlinearity,” *Phononics 2025*, Seoul, Korea, June 2025 (invited).
16. “Remote Nucleation and Stationary Domain Walls in Tristable Magnetoelastic Lattices,” *Indian Conference on Applied Mechanics (INCAM)*, Warangal, India, July 2024 (invited).
15. “Nonlinear dynamics of topological Kagome lattice,” *IUTAM Symposium on Nonlinear dynamics for design of mechanical systems across different length/time scales*, Tsukuba, Japan, Aug 2023.
14. “Nonlinear Dynamics of Topological Lattices,” *European Nonlinear Oscillations Conference*, Lyon, France, July 2022.
13. “Topological mechanics and nonlinearity,” *American Physical Society*, Online, March 2021.
12. “Self-induced topological transition in a nonlinear phononic lattice,” *Metamaterials*, Rome, Italy, Sept 2019.
11. “Dynamic topological transition in a nonlinear phononic lattice,” *International Congress on Ultrasonics*, Bruges, Belgium, Sept 2019.

10. "Self-induced topological transition in a nonlinear phononic lattice," *Phononics*, Tucson, AZ, June 2019.
9. "Topological manipulation of stress waves by tunable 1D and 2D mechanical structures," *IUTAM Symposium on Acoustic/elastic Metamaterials, Their Design and Applications*, Beijing, China, June 2018 (invited).
8. "Subwavelength and directional topological waveguides in thin plates using pseudo spin Hall Effect," *American Physical Society*, LA, CA, March 2018.
7. "Demonstrating in-situ topological band transition using highly tunable phononic crystals," *ASME-IMECE*, Tampa, FL, Nov 2017.
6. "Extreme control of impulse transmission by cylindrical phononic crystals," *SIAM on Applications of Dynamical Systems*, Snowbird, UT, May 2017 (invited).
5. "Experimental verification of topological band-transition in one-dimensional phononic crystals," *SPIE-Smart Structures/NDE*, Portland, OR, March 2017.
4. "Manipulation of elastic waves in graded mechanical metamaterials," *ASME-IMECE*, Phoenix, AZ, Nov 2016.
3. "Acoustic non-reciprocator based on topologically non-trivial band-gaps," *ASME-IMECE*, Phoenix, AZ, Nov 2016.
2. "Unique Impact Mitigation Mechanism in Granular Dimer Chains," *ASME-IMECE*, Houston, TX, Nov 2015.
1. "Numerical and experimental verifications of resonance and anti-resonance phenomena in granular dimer chains," *ASME-McMat*, Seattle, WA, July 2015.

Professional Society Memberships

- IPA: Indian Physics Association (2025–)
- APS: American Physical Society (2021–2025)
- ASME: American Society of Mechanical Engineers (2015–2017)
- SIAM: Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics (2017–2018)

Archival Journal Reviews

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| • American Journal of Physics | • Nature Communications |
| • APL Materials | • New Journal of Physics |
| • Applied Physics Letters | • Nonlinear Dynamics |
| • Archives of Computational Methods in Eng. | • npj Acoustics |
| • Communications Physics | • Physica B |
| • Crystals | • Physica Scripta |
| • Extreme Mechanics Letters | • Physical Review Applied |
| • International Journal of Mechanical Sciences | • Physical Review B |
| • Journal of Applied Mechanics | • Physical Review E |
| • Journal of Applied Physics | • Physical Review Letters |
| • Journal of Physics A | • Physical Review Materials |
| • Journal of Physics D | • Reports on Progress in Physics |
| • Journal of the Acoustical Society of America | • Scientific Reports |
| • Journal of the Mechanics and Physics of Solids | • Smart Materials and Structures |
| • Journal of Vibration and Acoustics | • Ultrasonics |

STUDENTS AND POST-DOCS

Post-doctoral Fellows Supervised

Name	Period	Current Employer
Abhigna Bhatt	11/2025 – present	IISc
Prabith K	6/2022 – 12/2024	CNRS, France
Anusree Ray	6/2022 – 12/2024 Co-advisor: Prof. V. Dabade	University of Galway, Ireland

Chaired Doctoral Degrees

Name	Dissertation Title	Completed Year	Current Employer
G. S. Srikanth (AE)	Low-frequency bandgap metamaterials <i>PMRF Fellow</i>	Comprehensive Exam: 3/2024	IISc
Samanvay Anand (AE)	Transition waves in magnetoelastic lattices (Co-advisor: Prof. V. Dabade)	Comprehensive Exam: 9/2023	IISc
Harshit K. Sandhu (AE)	Dynamics of elastic time crystals	Comprehensive Exam: 6/2023	IISc

Chaired Masters (Research) Degrees

Name	Dissertation Title	Completed Year	Current Employer
Jayalakshmi K (AE)	Reservoir computing using a mechanical oscillator	—	IISc
Udbhav Vishwakarma (AE)	Deformation-based topological lattices and their edge states	11/2024	Georgia Institute of Technology, USA

Chaired Masters (Course) Degrees

Name	Project Title	Completed Year	Current Employer
Yashkumar Patil (AE)	Fluid-structure interaction of shocks on flexible plates	—	IISc
Bharath Kumar S (AE)	FEM-ML driven bandgap optimization in inertial amplification metamaterials	—	IISc
Anshuman (AE)	Rigid-link and strain-energy-based design for space deployable structures	6/2025	DRDO
Kapila Ramya Krishna (AE)	Analysis of a conical frustum under hypersonic pulsation regime	6/2025	Triveni Turbine Ltd.
Panchal Anand Jayeshbhai (AE)	Origami-inspired bi-stable, inflatable, load Bearing deployable boom for space application	6/2024	Ola Electric
Govardhan K (AE)	Impact-induced wave propagation in metamaterials	6/2024	DRDO

Project Associates Supervised

Name	Period	Next Employer
Murthaza Irfan A V	10/2022 – 6/2025	King Abdullah University of Science and Technology, Saudi Arabia
Saurav Dutta	6/2023 – 7/2024	Vizuara AI Labs
Ahamed Ali N	7/2023 – 6/2024	Johns Hopkins University, USA
Mohit Dhanda	6/2022 – 11/2022	University of Waterloo, Canada
Renganath Rengarajan	5/2022 – 11/2022	Airbus
Johnson Adams PS	12/2021 – 7/2022	Columbia University, USA

Undergraduate Project Students Supervised (External)

Name	Project Title	Period	Affiliation
S Roshan Kumar, Sahana Rao, and Varshini V Y	A High-Stability, Reconfigurable Metamaterial for Space Structures	2025–26	PES University

Undergraduate Interns Supervised (as a part of science outreach)

Name	Period	Affiliation
Rishiraj Krishan	7/2026 – 8/2026	NERIST, Arunachal Pradesh
Pranav N M	6/2026 – 7/2026	IIT Madras
Nandini Sanavda	5/2026 – 7/2026	IIT Kharagpur
Vaishnavi Vijay Devgire	5/2025 – 7/2025	IEST Shibpur
Adinarayan Agaram	5/2025 – 7/2025	IIT Madras
Avinash Umashankar	1/2024 – 5/2024	Sastra Deemed University
Vikramaditya Agrawal	5/2023 – 7/2023	NIT Tiruchirappalli
Vedant Vijaykrishnan	5/2023 – 7/2023	Manipal Institute of Technology

Visiting Scholars Supervised

Name	Period	Affiliation
Ankush Yadav	11/2023 – 2/2024	Graduate Student, Technion - Israel Institute of Technology

TEACHING EXPERIENCE**Indian Institute of Science (2021 – Present)**

Course Number	Title	Semester	Registered	Responded	Course Evaluation	Instructor Evaluation
AE 264	<i>Vibrations</i>	Jan 2026	6	4	4.75	4.75
AE 291	<i>Nonlinear Dynamics</i>	Jan 2025	14	6	4.50	4.33
AE 351A	<i>Wave Propagation in Designed Materials</i>	Jan 2025	7	3	5.00	5.00
AE 211	<i>Mathematical Methods of Aerospace Engineers</i>	Aug 2024	44	24	4.54	4.50
AE 264	<i>Vibrations</i>	Jan 2024	3	2	4.50	4.50
AE 351A	<i>Wave Propagation in Designed Materials</i>	Aug 2023	9	9	4.82	4.67
AE 211	<i>Mathematical Methods of Aerospace Engineers</i>	Jan 2023	31	18	4.06	4.72
AE 211	<i>Mathematical Methods of Aerospace Engineers (online)</i>	Jan 2022	29	12	4.25	4.36

Scale: 0 (poor) to 5 (excellent).

Other Teaching Experience

- *Architected Matter: Engineering Waves with Structure*, CISM-IISc workshop on “Emerging Topics in Architected & Multiscale Materials, Soft Robotics, and Data-Driven Model Discovery” (July 21–25, 2025)
- *Introduction to Nonlinear Vibrations and Waves*, Le Mans University (1/2020 – 3/2020)
- *Design of novel materials and structures: a fusion of art, mathematics, and science*, a study-abroad course at Queensland University of Technology, Brisbane, Australia (8/2018 – 9/2018)

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE ACTIVITIES

Department and Institute Service

Indian Institute of Science

- UG Program Coordination Committee member, IISc Aero, March 2026 – present
- Department Curriculum Committee member, IISc Aero, March 2026 – present
- Medal Committee member, IISc Aero, Nov 2025
- Interview Panelist for incoming research students, Structures, IISc Aero, Nov 2025
- Interview Panelist, ISRO/NAL sponsored MTech, June 2025
- Interview Panelist for incoming research students, Structures, IISc Aero, May 2025
- Senate Nominee in Department of Physics (2), Mechanical Engineering (1), Civil Engineering (3), Materials Engineering (1).
- PMRF Review Committee member for three students (excluding own students)
- Interview Panelist for incoming research students, Structures, IISc Aero, May 2024
- Faculty Organizer, Aerospace Research Students’ Symposium (AERES), Jan 2024
- Medal Committee member, IISc Aero, Dec 2023
- Faculty Organizer, Aerospace Research Students’ Symposium (AERES), Jan 2023
- Interview Panelist for incoming research students, Structures, IISc Aero, May 2022
- Interview Panelist, Defense/DRDO sponsored MTech, May 2022
- Website Committee member, IISc Aero, 2022 – present
- Medal Committee member, IISc Aero, Dec 2021
- Interview Panelist for incoming research students, Structures, IISc Aero, Nov 2021

Conference/Workshop Organizing Activities

- Session Chair, KOZWaves 2026, Sydney, Australia, 2026
- Co-organizer, CISM-IISc Workshop (first in India), Bengaluru, India, 2025
- Session Chair, Phononics, Seoul, Korea, 2025
- Session Chair, INCAM, Warangal, India, 2024
- Technical Committee member, SAEINDIA-AeroCON, Bengaluru, 2024
- Session Chair, IUTAM Symposium, Tsukuba, Japan, 2023

Science Outreach

- Two Frontiers in Aerospace Engineering: Origami and Metamaterials, IISc-Agastya Science Enrichment Program, 2024 and 2026 (Lectured about 80 selected high school students from various regions across India; mentored five students for a 2-week project)

EXTERNAL COLLABORATORS

- Georgios Theocharis, CNRS, France
- Panayotis Kevrekidis, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, USA
- Nicholas Boechler, University of California San Diego, USA
- Alexander Vakakis, University of Illinois, Urbana Champaign, USA
- Daniel Torrent, Universitat Jaume I, Spain
- Vassos Achilleos, CNRS, France
- Dimitri Frantzeskakis, National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Greece
- Fotios Diakonos, National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Greece
- Charalampos Skokos, University of Cape Town, South Africa
- Johan Christensen, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain
- Feng Li, Beijing Institute of Technology, China
- Eunho Kim, Jeonbuk National University, Republic of Korea

[Last updated: September 6, 2026. End of CV]